

## Problem No. 2 (10 Points):

### Solution:

Vietnamese names of these European countries are similar to their English names, but much shorter and adjusted to Vietnamese pronunciation (probably, they even were borrowed directly from English). The main idea of pairing up the names and their translations is the similarity of the first sounds:

Áo – Austria

Đan Mạch – Denmark

Phần Lan – Finland

Ý – Italay

In the pair Sweden – Switzerland the element *Điễn*, which is similar to English *-den*, helps us to choose the correct answer:

Thụy Điễn – Swe-den

Thụy Sỹ – Swi-tzer-land

Vietnamese *Lan*, as we can guess, corresponds to English *-land* (Switzerland is an exception, as in English it consists of 3 syllables). So, Belgium is *Bỉ* (and not Ba Lan) and *Na Uy* is probably Norway (and not the Netherlands).

Poland is probably *Ba Lan* (and not *Hà Lan*), as [p] is quite similar to [b].

As for the word *Hà Lan*, we can guess from the assignment 2 that something is “wrong” with it.

#### Assignment 1.

Áo – Austria

Ba Lan – Poland

Bỉ – Belgium

Đan Mạch – Denmark

Hà Lan – Netherlands (?)

Na Uy – Norway

Phần Lan – Finland

Thụy Điễn – Sweden

Thụy Sỹ – Switzerland

Ý – Italay

#### Assignment 2.

Vietnamese name of the Netherlands (*Hà Lan*) probably comes not from the word *Netherlands*, but from the word *Holland*, which is originally the name of one of the parts of the Netherlands, but is sometimes used to refer to the whole country.